

Narayan Ashanahalli

[LinkedIn](#) | (412)-626-2332 | nashanah@alumni.cmu.edu | <https://www.narayan.works/>

Hi, I'm a product designer and prototyper working across physical UX and human-AI interaction. I design and build full-stack prototypes that explore new ways people interact with intelligent systems through hardware, voice, gesture, and spatial interfaces. Looking to join a team building future-facing device experiences through craft, prototyping, and natural interaction.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

HCI Researcher | [Pointobot](#)

January 2026 – May 2026

Master's Thesis

- Built a **2-DOF laser mechanism** (lab assistant) with voice input and **LLM-based** spatial reasoning — physically pointing to real-world locations in a shared lab environment as a primary communication channel.
- Investigated **pointing** and **deictics** as an interaction paradigm for **HAII** — designing for a world where AI references physical space directly rather than describing it through language.
- Developed a **responsive gesture library** for communicating **robot state** through physical movement, removing the need for screen or voice output for a **lab prototype** currently used by **15+ students daily**.

Product Designer | [Dot Threads](#)

November 2025 – January 2026

Browser Extension for Knowledge Management

- Designed and shipped **Dot Threads**, a **Chrome extension** that turns **saved links** into a **spatial graph**, helping users **organize, edit and share** research by **context** and **relationships**, alternative to the traditional bookmarking.
- Validated the workflow through **25 user** interviews across 3 CMU departments and shipped a **4-click save flow** with **right-click capture, contextual tagging, and graph-based retrieval**, live on the Web Store with **10+ active users**.

Interaction Designer | [Piko](#)

March 2025 – May 2025

Context-Aware Wearable Assistant

- Designed a **soft robotic companion** detecting doom-scrolling posture with **91% accuracy** using a custom-trained computer vision model, delivering peripheral physical feedback as a **habit-building nudge**.
- Developed the companion's **emotive behavior system**, translating 4 emotional states into **servo-based motion patterns** to create social feedback without language.
- Owned the **CV-to-motion integration layer**, training a custom model on **600+ images in Roboflow** and connecting posture detection to real-time servo feedback across a **3-node Raspberry Pi system**.

WORK EXPERIENCE

UX Designer & Researcher

December 2024 – Present

Lab 4 Cybernetics | Pittsburgh, PA

- Led the design and full-stack development of the Lab for Cybernetics' digital platform, replacing fragmented Google Docs and Notion workflows with a modular **Notion-based CMS**, increasing **user participation by 80%**.
- Shipped an **OTP-secured AI matchmaking feature** for **25+ practitioners and scholars**, using profile submissions, research interests, expertise, AI-generated **topic chips**, and **match reasoning** to recommend relevant collaborators.
- Implemented the platform with Next.js/TypeScript frontend, Notion API, and Gmail SMTP, with **modular CMS** workflows and **dev-documentation** for future maintainers and non-technical content updates.

Project Designer

August 2023 – July 2024

Studio Chintala | Bangalore, India

- Led research, concept development, and delivery of Working, Living & Innovating, translating **behavioral field user research** across an industrial campus into a phased design strategy that secured **\$10,000 Phase I approval**.
- Developed a **systems-based intervention framework** across 5 spatial domains, presenting **cost-tiered prototypes** to stakeholders and driving alignment between **worker experience goals** and **operational constraints**.

Machine Learning Intern

August 2020 – December 2020

Uniworks Design | Hyderabad, India

- Constructed training dataset for **ArP-Gen GAN model**: validated 2,000+ architectural floor plans with feature labels

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Pittsburgh, PA

Master of Advanced Architectural Design

May 2026

JNAFA University

Hyderabad, IN

Bachelor of Architecture

July 2023

SKILLS

Design: Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Visual Design, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, Hardware Prototyping, User Testing, Systems Thinking, Motion Design, Human-AI Interaction, Storytelling

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Framer, Miro, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, Indesign, Adobe XD, Notion, ProtoPie, Voiceflow, Procreate, Google Analytics, Heap, Hotjar, Userlytics, GitHub, Rhino 3D, Blender

Technical: HTML, CSS, React, TypeScript, Python, API Integration, Version Control (Git), SQL, MCP, AI-assisted coding with Cursor, Claude Code,